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LIVE UPDATES

DUBAI SEES DH111B REAL ESTATE PROJECTS IN H1

Figures show continued confidence in Dubai's property and investment environment

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Dubai's real estate sector recorded strong growth during the first half of 2026, according to data released by the Dubai Land Department. A total of 104 real estate projects were completed, compared to 75 during the first half of 2025, representing an increase of more than 38.7 per cent. The total investment value of these projects exceeded Dh111 billion, compared to Dh73 billion in the first half of 2025, marking growth of 52 per cent.

These results reflect the strength of Dubai's real estate sector and growing investor confidence in the emirate's economic environment.

Steady progress

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, noted that the real estate figures recorded during the first half of 2026 demonstrate that Dubai continues to make steady progress towards achieving the objectives of the Dubai Economic Agenda D33 to double the size of Dubai's economy by 2033 and consolidate its position among the world's top three cities.

The latest growth in Dubai's real estate projects reflects the significant liquidity and capital inflows into the market. The first half of 2026 witnessed a substantial increase in the launch and development of new real estate investment projects, reflecting a strategic direction among developers and investors to introduce landmark developments that further enhance Dubai's urban landscape.

Dubai Land Department data also showed significant growth in residential supply. The number of new real estate units increased by more than 36 per cent to reach 24,537, compared to 18,043 during the first half of last year.

The total completed and ready-for-handover built-up area grew by more than 23.4 per cent, reaching 1.95 million square metres, compared to 1.58 million square metres during the same period last year.

The value of land allocated to projects recorded an exceptional increase of more than 135 per cent, reaching Dh19.46 billion, compared to Dh8.27 billion during the corresponding period in 2025. Meanwhile, the total area of land allocated to completed projects more than doubled, reaching approximately one million square metres.

NEW APM SYSTEM

A 50-kilometre automated people mover (APM) will be built at Dubai's Al Maktoum International Airport (DWC), set to be the world's largest airport APM system. The system will connect nine stations across the future airport and will comprise 165 automated people-mover vehicles.

Developer Mitsubishi Heavy Industries (MHI) said completion is scheduled for December 2031, ahead of the planned opening of the new airport in 2032.

The system forms part of Dubai's massive expansion of Al Maktoum International, which is being developed to eventually handle 260 million passengers a year.

MHI said the approximately 50km network will be more than six times the length of the current longest airport APM system, the approximately 8km Skylink at Dallas Fort Worth International Airport in the US.

— Dhanusha Gokulan, Chief Reporter

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Trump declares 'economic D-Day' as Iran refuses to bend

US President threatens Iran's economic lifelines as Tehran rejects pressure

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump has threatened Iran with what he calls the "most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country", opening a new front in a war that has resisted months of military pressure and diplomacy — even as Tehran signals it has no intention of backing down.

The US president declared an "economic D-Day" against Iran after a 60-day ceasefire window expired on Monday without a diplomatic settlement, threatening punishment not only against Tehran but any country, bank or business that helps keep its economy alive. "ANY country that allows its financial institutions, businesses, airports, or government entities to provide any type of lifeline to Iran will itself face TREMENDOUS Economic Consequences," Trump wrote on Truth Social.

He singled out "oil smuggling, swap lines, cash transfers, exchange houses, ship registries, front companies", saying: "It all needs to stop NOW."

> **Iran's economy has been battered by the war and inflation, with food prices more than doubling since July last year.**

Washington has already imposed waves of sanctions on foreign banks and companies doing business with Iran. The latest threat signals an attempt to dramatically widen that economic squeeze as military action has failed to force Tehran's surrender.

Iran rejects threat

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi dismissed Trump's announcement as another round of "failed policies" that would bring further US failures and deepen Iranian hostility towards Washington.

The economic pressure is already severe. Iran's economy has been battered by the war and inflation, with food prices more than doubling since July last year. State-affiliated Iranian media reported that staples including eggs, rice, meat and bread have effectively become "luxury goods" for many.

Hormuz Iran's leverage

But Tehran retains a powerful economic weapon of its own. Iran has sharply restricted marine traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, helping drive up global energy costs and increasing political pressure on Trump ahead of November's US midterm elections.

Oman yesterday warned that lasting security in Hormuz could come only through regional peace, restraint and diplomacy, while calling for international efforts to protect navigation and energy flows.

Meanwhile, the USS George Washington aircraft carrier has arrived in the Middle East and will relieve the USS Abraham Lincoln, whose extended deployment during the Iran war has raised concerns about crew welfare.

Regional tensions persist

The confrontation also continues to reverberate across the region. Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis said yesterday they had launched drone attacks against Najran Airport and an Aramco facility in southern Saudi Arabia.

The claim came after Iran's Revolutionary Guards warned that Riyadh would be "unable to contain" the Houthis as their attacks intensify. Separately, the UK Maritime Trade Operations reported that six armed people boarded a tanker in the Gulf of Aden after approaching in an unauthorised vessel, seized control and redirected it to Somalia.

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Iconic Toyota Building to be pulled down next year

It is among the first buildings on SZR

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

The iconic Toyota Building on Sheikh Zayed Road is set to be demolished in 2027. It brings an end to one of the city's most well-known residential buildings.

Residents with existing rental contracts can remain in the building until December 2026.

The Nasser Rashid Lootah Building was completed in 1974, when Dubai was far less densely developed than it is today. The 15-storey residential complex, standing about 65 metres tall, was among the first three buildings in the area near the First Roundabout on Sheikh Zayed Road.

It became widely known as the Toyota Building after carrying a neon Toyota sign on its roof for around 40 years.

The bright red insignia, which was first installed atop the 15-storey residential building in 1981, was removed in 2018 when the advertising contract expired.

However, in June 2022, Toyota UAE installed the iconic logo back after a hiatus of nearly four years.

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